

hitotoki

Brand Guidelines

This project explores deliberate use of AI tools. I was in control of the design decisions while AI merely executed under my direction. Strictly not allowed to make design decisions on its own.

Designed by Patrick Eng
AI used: ChatGPT

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Brand Overview

Our Purpose

Our purpose is provide customers the resources to create quality bonding time with anyone.

Brand Pillars of BX

1. Product & Services

What are the company's core products and services?

• Original board games

• Membership
    • News, points for discounts, etc.
    • "Hito Club" - Hito also means person,
        • Free membership
    • "Toki Club" - Toki means time
        • Paid membership
    • Early/special access to new games and events

What features and benefits do they offer customers?

• Allows customers to play any game for free in store

• Customers can buy and take home to play

**Note - Things that are considered "board games" are:*
Card driven: Exploding Kittens, Cards Against Humanity
Tile laying: Dominoes
Dexterity: Jenga

2. Brand Substance: Authentic & Enduring

What is its purpose, mission, vision, and core values?

Core Value:
• Togetherness

• Strategic thinking

• Community

Mission:
“To bring people together.”

What principles appear to guide its culture and decision-making?

• To foster generational relationships with consumers

• Promote the desire to stay offline

3. Brand Positioning: Distinctive & Precise

Who is the primary target audience?

• Young adults

• Families

Who are its main competitors?

• Nintendo

• Xbox (Microsoft)

• Playstation (Sony)

• Other forms of entertainment

What are its key differentiators or unique value proposition?

• Lighthearted fun in spirit

• Competitive/challenging in mind

• All employee involvement (from CEO and C-Suite to new hires)

• Intentionality of time and space

4. Brand Persona: Relevant & Aspirational

What personality traits best describe the brand?

1. inviting
2. refined
3. imaginative
4. thoughtful

How does the brand behave and interact with customers?

• Host events frequently

• Social media

• Employees of the company are encouraged to join and play games with customers

5. Brand Voice: Empathetic & Committed

How does the brand sound across its website, social media, advertising, packaging, and customer service?

• Conversational, warm, considered, inviting

Is its communication formal, casual, expert, humorous, direct, or inspirational?

1. Casual
2. Familiar
3. Conversational
4. Understated/implied

What messaging themes appear consistently?

• Quality bonding time and togetherness

Does the brand use a tagline or storytelling framework?

• Elements of time to help with the storytelling

• Tagline: “Our time, offline”

What words, tones, or messaging styles should be avoided?

1. Aggression
2. Excessive technical terms
3. Formal/corporate
4. Exclusivity
5. Childish

5. Brand Voice: Empathetic & Committed (Continued)

6. Overly energetic

How consistent is the voice across different touchpoints?

• Overall fairly consistent, tone is the only thing that varies based on the platform being used

• Advertising is different from packaging

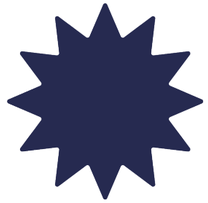
Primary Visual Identity



Primary Lockup

hitotoki

Wordmark



Junihoshi Icon

hitotoki

hitotoki

hitotoki

hitotoki

hitotoki

hitotoki



Color Palette

In the order they appear:

1. Night Sky — #262A50 (Primary)
2. Lunar White — #EBF2FA
3. Day Sky — #3083DC
4. Sunset Orange — #FFA83F
5. Solar Yellow — #F3C969

Combinations:

1. Night Sky & Lunar White
2. Lunar White & Night Sky
3. Day Sky & Lunar White
4. Sunset Orange & Night Sky
5. Solar Yellow & Night Sky

Typography:

Typeface:
Gabarito

NOTE: wordmark is made by with Gabarito +50 tracking and remove the tittles (dots)

hitotoki

Title: Bold 20 pt

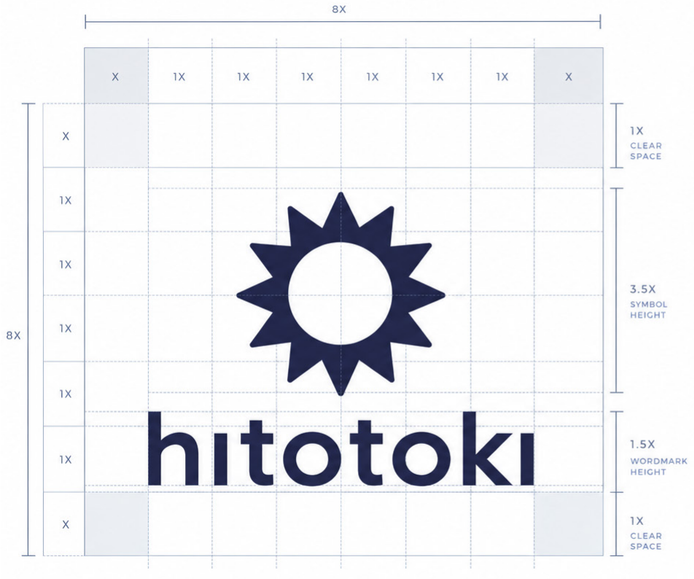
Head: Bold 13 pt

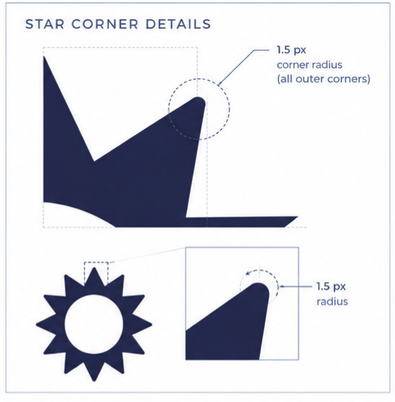
Subhead: 11 pt

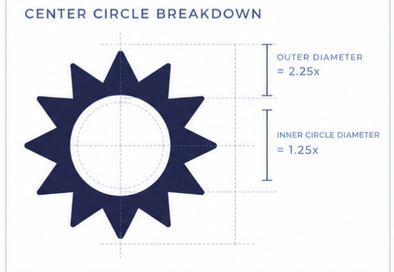
Body: Regular 9 pt

Note: Regular 7 pt

Secondary Visual Assets







lockup grid system





Secondary Icons

Creating New Variations & Applying Assets

When creating new variations:

• Icons of any kind are allowed as long as they fit within the dimensions of the inner circle provided in the lockup grid system provided on the previous page

• All icons must be solid filled and reflect a punch out feel

• Keep new icons as simple and straightforward as possible

• Keep to the color combinations

• May introduce #E8B7C1 - Sakura Pink for sakura related things ONLY in the flagship store. Otherwise, don't use.

DO NOT:

• Create a horizontal logo

• Add any effects to the .svg or .png for logos (back lit effects is ok for renders)

• Tilt or change the orientation of any assets

• Add new color combinations

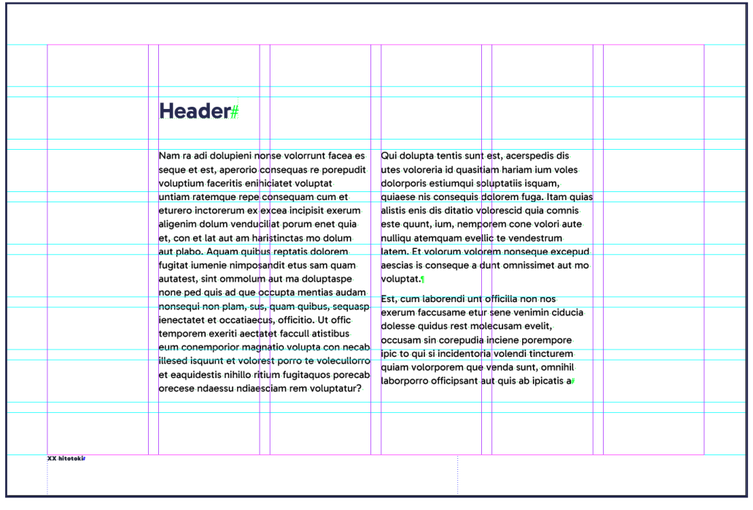
Experiential Identity Guidelines

Print layout and grid system

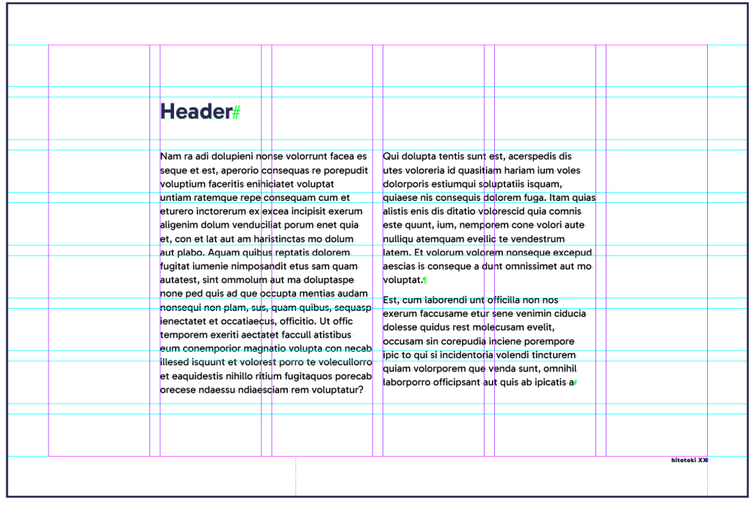
9 x 6 inch
6 columns
7 rows

0.125 gutter

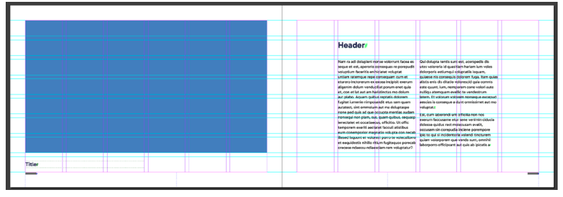
Note: Web layout and grid is very similar. Just using single page as reference instead of spread.



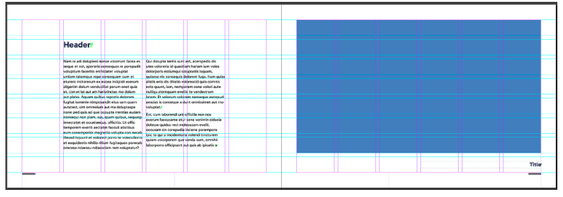
Layout - Print Left Page



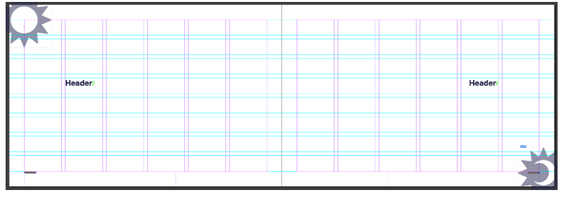
Layout - Print Right Page



Hero Image Left



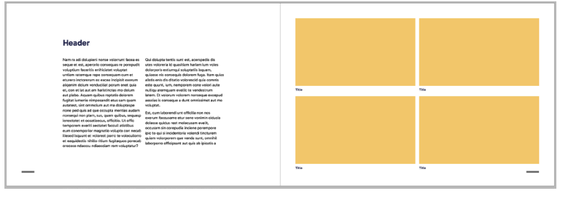
Hero Image Right



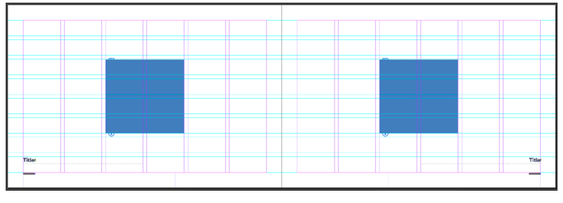
Title Page - Left and Right



Multi Page Left



Multi Page Right



Solo Highlight - Left and Right

Layout should reflect togetherness (feeling of being whole or part of a greater)

Layout should make readers slow down when reading

Layouts require breathing room on all sides

No rulers as dividers

- **BUT color blocking is ok**

Sun and Moon secondary icons should only be used for section headers

Visual Applications



hitotoki Headquarters - Exterior



hitotoki Headquarters - Lobby (6 pm)



hitotoki Headquarters - junihoshi cafe



hitotoki Flagship Store



hitotoki Flagship Cafe - junihoshi cafe Interior



hitotoki Sakura HVAC Diffusion



juniyaki Packaging



hitotoki cafe - juniyaki



Wayfinding - Flagship Signage



hitotoki Merch - Pocket Notebooks



hitotoki Merch - Pens



hitotoki x KINTO Collaboration: Tumbler Collection

Note: KINTO is a Japanese lifestyle and tableware brand



Employee Uniform



hitotoki Original Board Game - moonward



Flagship Exclusive: Sakura Scented Cards



Founder's Business Card

Note: KINTO is a Japanese lifestyle and tableware brand

AI Prompt Guide

Approved/Recommended AI

ChatGPT

• Use within a ChatGPT project file to contain all sources and memory

• Upload this document + brand assets before using prompt

• Can be used to reliably render images

• Often gets logos and icons wrong on the first try but will correct after reuploading the correct asset

• Better at rendering non-living imagery (architectural environments, products, etc)

• It is OK at rendering people

• Flexible prompt can be used for specific details if desired but not required

• Visual language, voice, tone, and constraints are all listed within the permanenet prompt guidelines

• Converse with AI if anything is unclear, but understanding hitotoki stands for is integral

Note: Had diversity in inaugural render testings

Permanent

Defined by the design department. Fixed. Applies to every project without exception.

1. How We Work

I will make all design decisions. You will execute the instructions without independently introducing design changes. If instructions are unclear, you must request clarification before proceeding. All work must meet established brand standards, and any necessary revisions must be discussed before implementation. You may identify issues and recommend improvements but must obtain approval before implementing any changes. Before beginning design work, establish a comprehensive identification system for all brand assets to ensure consistent referencing and execution. I will provide the main brand assets. Be sure to use the uploaded assets when executing deliverables.

2. Brand Strategy

hitotoki is a board game company offering original and public-domain games through flagship and franchise stores, supported by memberships and in-store refreshments. Its mission is “To bring people together,” providing opportunities for meaningful bonding through offline play. Rooted in community, quality time, strategic thinking, and togetherness, hitotoki encourages lasting relationships and shared experiences across generations.

The brand is inviting and approachable, intentional, imaginative, and thoughtful, balancing lighthearted enjoyment with strategic challenge. Employees at every level, including leadership, are encouraged to play alongside customers, reinforcing equality and connection. Customers can play available games in-store and purchase games to enjoy at home. The primary audiences are young adults and families. Always write “hitotoki” in lowercase, including at the beginning of sentences and in titles.

Communication must be conversational, warm, considered, inviting, familiar, and understated. Emphasize quality bonding time, togetherness, and the significance of shared moments.

Use time as a recurring storytelling element, drawing from ichi-go ichi-e, the Japanese concept that every encounter is unique and cannot be replicated. Avoid aggressive, overly technical, corporate, exclusive, childish, or excessively energetic language. Maintain a consistent voice while adapting tone to each communication channel.

hitotoki expresses refinement through thoughtful design, comfort, and intentional experiences rather than luxury, prestige, or exclusivity. Environments should feel sophisticated yet approachable, balancing architectural simplicity with warmth and opportunities for spontaneous social interaction.

Spaces should invite participation rather than admiration, ensuring that design supports togetherness, equality, and meaningful shared experiences.

Brand experiences should encourage customers to disconnect from digital distractions and appreciate the present. Physical and sensory applications reinforce this through communal gameplay, interactive installations, warm Japanese-inspired refreshments, and subtle sakura fragrances.

3. Visual Principles

hitotoki’s visual identity combines measured simplicity with imaginative expression. Maintain a clean, modern, refined aesthetic that allows playfulness to emerge through interaction, symbolism, and thoughtful variation rather than visual clutter.

Typography:
Use Gabarito Regular. The brand name “hitotoki” must always appear in lowercase across all applications, including headings, body copy, signage, and communications, regardless of grammatical conventions. The wordmark must never contain dots above either “i.” Preserve its established letterforms, proportions, and spacing.

Color Palette:
Night Sky — #262A50 (Primary)
Lunar White — #EBF2FA
Day Sky — #3083DC
Sunset Orange — #FFA83F
Solar Yellow — #F3C969

Primary Symbol:
Junihoshi, a twelve-pointed starburst with rounded corners. Its central circular area accommodates interchangeable pictograms representing different aspects of the brand. Preserve the original starburst geometry and use only approved symbol variations.

Logo System:
The primary lockup vertically combines Junihoshi above the hitotoki wordmark. Secondary variations incorporate a circle, crescent moon, cherry blossom, die, star, or chess rook within the symbol. A solid Junihoshi is also permitted. Use approved artwork without redrawing, distorting, or modifying its proportions. The hitotoki logo system consists of the approved wordmark, junihoshi symbol, and logo variations identified in the asset registry. The die, star, crescent, rook, and circle are interchangeable decorative symbols. The sakura is reserved for store-related applications. All approved assets serve as visual references for maintaining consistency in geometry, typography, proportions, and color.

Visual Applications:
Maintain consistent use of typography, color, and symbols across packaging, signage, stores, interactive installations, digital communications, and branded experiences. The visual identity should remain recognizable regardless of medium or application.

4. Generative Grammar

All visual outcomes must follow the established identity system, prioritizing consistency, clarity, and controlled variation.

Hierarchy:
Establish clear distinctions between primary information, supporting content, and decorative elements. Prioritize legibility and visual clarity. Use the primary logo as the dominant brand identifier when appropriate. Composition: Favor clean layouts, intentional spacing, balanced proportions, and sufficient negative space. Maintain consistent alignment and avoid unnecessary visual complexity.

Logo Construction:
Preserve the approved 245 × 180 px vertical lockup proportions. Position Junihoshi above the wordmark, centered horizontally. The wordmark must remain lowercase, without dots above the “i” characters, and fit within its specified 244 × 48 px construction area. Round Junihoshi’s outer corners by 1.5 px at the documented reference scale.

Symbol Construction:
Preserve Junihoshi’s twelve-point geometry and central circular area. Interchangeable pictograms must fit entirely within the circle’s width and height. Use simple, solid-filled silhouettes and negative space to achieve a clean punch-out effect. Do not introduce gradients, outlines, excessive detail, or unapproved symbols.

Consistency:
Use established brand assets, Gabarito Regular, and the approved color palette. Do not alter logo geometry, typography, or icon proportions. Maintain the brand’s refined, inviting character across all touchpoints. Always write “hitotoki” in lowercase, including at the beginning of sentences and in titles.

Variation:
Introduce visual diversity through approved color combinations, pictograms, compositions, and applications without changing the underlying identity system. Playfulness should emerge through creative arrangements and interactive experiences rather than excessive decoration. Logo variations may be adapted or expanded to suit different applications, provided they remain consistent with hitotoki’s brand identity and themes. New symbols may be introduced within the junihoshi system when conceptually relevant. Maintain the established visual language, including geometric simplicity, proportions, and overall composition. The sakura remains exclusive to store-related applications. All new variations require approval before use.

Execution:
Generate outcomes that feel intentional, approachable, modern, and cohesive. Balance refinement with warmth and accessibility, avoiding visual expressions of luxury, prestige, or exclusivity that undermine the brand’s communal character. When a requested design conflicts with the established system, preserve brand consistency and request clarification rather than inventing new rules.

Flexible

5. Project Brief

Define the purpose, audience, context, and limitations of the application.

Application: [What is being designed?]

Purpose: [What should it accomplish?]

Target Audience: [Who will interact with it?]

Context: [Where and how will it be used?]

Constraints: [What limitations or requirements must be considered?]

6. Visual Direction

Specify how the permanent brand identity should be applied to this project.

Brand Assets: [Which existing assets and asset IDs must be used?]

Layout & Composition: [How should elements be arranged?]

Visual Hierarchy: [What should receive the most emphasis?]

Color & Typography: [Which approved colors and type treatments should be used?]

Project-Specific Direction: [What additional visual requirements or references apply?]

Restrictions: [What must remain unchanged or be excluded?]

7. What I Need From You

Define the expected output and its technical requirements.

Deliverables: [What needs to be produced?]

Dimensions: [Size, scale, or aspect ratio.]

Format: [File types or presentation format.]

Technical Specifications: [Resolution, color mode, materials, or production requirements.]

Functionality: [Interactive or operational requirements, if applicable.]

References: [Supporting files, images, or models.]

Completion Criteria: [What conditions must be met for approval?]

Approved/Prohibit Styles and Terms

• Refer to the “Creating New Variations & Applying Assets” after the AI Prompt Guide page for what is acceptable for outputs and styles

• Additionally, only the typeface of Gabarito may be used

• Weights may be used for diferent character or paragraph styles

Required

• Refer to the “Creating New Variations & Applying Assets” after the AI Prompt Guide page for what is acceptable for variations as well as what to avoid

• Required visual language must be clean, refined, but not high-end as hitotoki is a brand that welcomes all. The priority is togetherness

• Additionally, visual language must reflect intentional use of Japanese minimalistic design. No rulers, no loud elements, no shouting

• Voice and tone are conversational and welcoming. Avoid use of aggression, excessive technical terms, formal/corporate, and exclusive language.

Checklist

• Does the generated content comply with the brand’s visual guidelines?

• Does the generated content use the right logo or other brand assets?

• Does the generated content match the tone of the brand?

• Does the imagery generated have any errors in relation to the brand?

• Does the imagery generated have any errors in relation to the output?

• Do the people in the imagery generated look natural, if applicable?


hitotoki